

Ratnavarṣaṇadhāraṇī · Toh 775 · Derge Kangyur

རའི་པ་ཆེ་བརྒྱ་བའ་གི་ཟདུས།

This short text, which can be rendered in English as The Dhāraṇī for Presenting Precious Jewels, appears in the Tibetan as Rin po che brdar ba'i gzungs, and its closing lines also give it the name of a dhāraṇī for circumambulation; its Sanskrit title is not firmly attested in the source lines, so it is best described generally. It is a brief dhāraṇī, a ritual formula of protective and merit-making speech, which opens with an offering verse imagining the expanse of space filled with jewels, then pays homage to the Tathāgata Ratnaketu, the Banner of Jewels, and gives a mantra beginning with the syllable oṃ and invoking jewels and the victory of jewels. The text promises that reciting it while making a single circumambulation, the traditional act of walking clockwise around a stūpa or sacred object, is equal in merit to immeasurable circumambulations. It is Toh 775 in the Kangyur, the Tibetan collection of translated Buddhist scriptures, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts.

Imagining that the expanse of space is filled with them, I make this offering.

Here ends the dhāraṇī for presenting precious jewels.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha Ratnaketu, the Banner of Jewels.

Namo bhagavate ratnaketurājāya, tathāgatāya, arhate, samyaksaṃbuddhāya.
Tadyathā: Oṃ ratne ratne mahāratne ratnavijaye svāhā.

By reciting this and making a single circumambulation, one will have performed immeasurable circumambulations.

The dhāraṇī for circumambulation

Translator's Notes

- The mantra is given here as it appears in the Tibetan transliteration, with minor normalization. The readings "mahārahṇe" and "samyakṣaṃdurādhāya" in the source look like scribal corruptions, probably for "mahāratne" and "samyakṣaṃbuddhāya," so the Sanskrit above is reconstructed and the Tibetan spelling is not fully reliable. The passage breaks off at its final line, where the heading of the next dhāraṇī, on circumambulation, begins and its text is not included. The first sentence is the closing of the preceding text and the colophon "dhāraṇī for presenting precious jewels" is rendered literally. The Tibetan "rin po che brdar ba" is somewhat ambiguous, and "presenting" or "offering" jewels is the most likely sense.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.